

Cryptic Crosswords: MS Edition

Aiden Lim

1 Introduction

Recently, there has been an Instagram account on the rise that promotes these types of puzzles. Cryptic crossword clues are just like regular crossword clues, except with a hint of wordplay. Each hint has one clue comprised of wordplay and definition, with either component coming first. For example, the clue

“Four escape alive behind the last apartment story (4)”

has a definition of “story.” The wordplay bit is “Four escape alive behind the last apartment” After four, or “iv” escapes “alive,” we get “ale” which goes behind the “last” of “apartment,” which is the letter “t.” Putting “ale” behind “t” gets us “**tale**.”

Occasionally, two halves of the clue might be phrases that mean the same thing. In the clue

“An eating utensil divides into two parts (4),”

both halves of the clue: “eating utensil” and “divides into two parts” both refer to a “**fork**” which is the answer.

The following cryptic crossword clues, in the spirit of MS, all have answers related to math.

Have fun!

2 The Good Stuff (the clues):

1. Brainrot language adds up (5)

2. First famous entry remembered: “margins are tiny” (6)

3. Cousin excludes you before starting every wave (6)

4. An integral factor in the indiv I sorted (7)

5. I'd cut in on rearranged proofs (9)

6. Synchronizes labels on a set of axes (11)

7. M'lord even removes congruence! (3)

8. Apostrophe initially puts reader in mental excitement (5)

9. Revolutionary inverse to powers (7)

10. Apple alternative removed and after a penny, gets point of balance (8)

3 Hints:

Since I'm feeling nice, I'll give the parts of each clue that are the "definition" or say if it is a "double definition" clue.

1. double definition
2. The entire clue is both definition and wordplay!! This type of clue is called an "&lit."
3. wave
4. factors
5. proofs
6. double definition
7. congruence
8. apostrophe
9. double definition
10. point of balance